

look at how each of these four important parts of our lives are turned upside down by cyber crime.

- ▶ **Cyber crime against people:** This includes a wide variety of offenses. Criminals will hide behind fake promotions, offers, giveaways etc. while giving you the illusion of security to get you to give up your personal information. Impersonating institutions such as banks, they gain access to your info by convincing you that there's a problem with your account details and thereby ask you to 'rectify' it. Schemes such as the Nigerian letter scam or the chain-letter scams that were once practised via snail mail have now gone digital. Internet auction fraud is another way of duping people with non-delivery of product or misuse of credit card information. The trafficking of sexually explicit material including child pornography, which is illegal, is another major offense. Cyber defamation is committed when libellous claims about another individual are posted on a website or sent through an email. Social networks and chat services are not bereft of its presence. Online harassment or cyber bullying is a pretty common occurrence on such services. Yet another type of unwelcome engagement is cyber stalking –having your every action online followed



Criminals impersonate sites to get your sensitive information

- as and when it happens. In some of the more serious cases, the internet is used as a medium to locate individuals, engage them in conversation, invite them over for a personal meeting and then once the perpetrators meet the victim commit serious crimes such as rape, theft, murder etc.
- ▶ **Cyber crime against property:** basically involves the infiltration of computers with malicious software through websites, email or personal chats. These malware attacks could be just to destroy someone's computer or to steal information from them. These attacks deny the user access to his/her information while supplying the perpetrators with essential details about the victim. Theft of bandwidth, that is gaining unauthorized access to an internet connection, is also treated as a cyber crime.
- ▶ **Cyber crime against businesses:** These happen when the perpetrators